



Design Inspiration: Nahin Abrar Portfolio

Source: <https://nahin-abrar.vercel.app/>

Analyzed: September 2026

Purpose: Extract actionable design ideas to improve Nafi Ahmed's portfolio



Sections Observed

- Hero** — 3D sphere with metallic gold orbital ring, brand name cut by a horizontal rule
- About** — Dark floating card overlay on a warm off-white canvas
- Skills** — Sticky category headers with numbered skill cards
- Experience** — Light card container with left-column year timeline and right dark role cards
- Projects** — Editorial horizontal list with full-width line dividers
- Navigation Drawer** — 50% width sliding pitch-black overlay with oversized links
- Contact & Footer** — Callout quote, gold accents, marquee tickers, direct contact info



1. Color Palette & Theme

Base Colors

Role	Color	Usage
Light Canvas	#DCDCD9 / #D6D5CF	Page background — warm off-white, editorial "paper" feel
Dark Card	#000000 / #0A0A0A	Floating section containers (About, Skills, Contact)
Primary Text (Light BG)	#000000	Stark black for maximum contrast
Primary Text (Dark BG)	#FFFFFF	Crisp white
Secondary Text	#A1A1AA / #71717A	Subtext, captions, descriptions
Accent Gold	#D4AF37 / #C5A059	Highlights, 3D asset, dividers, icons

Aesthetic Strategy

- Dual-mode rhythm:** Alternate between the warm light canvas and pitch-black rounded cards as you scroll — creates strong visual hierarchy without a full dark/light toggle
- Vignette ambient effect:** Subtle dark glow frame around the viewport edges adds depth and focus
- No gradients** — stark flat contrast is the premium move here



2. Typography Choices

Font Pairing

- Primary:** Bold Neo-Grotesque Sans-Serif (similar to *Neue Haas Grotesk*, *Space Grotesk*, or *Inter Display*)
- Used for headings, navigation, body text
- Very high letter-spacing at display sizes
- Secondary / Accent:** Elegant italic serif (similar to *Playfair Display* or *Cormorant Garamond*)
- Used sparingly for single emphasized keywords in sentences
- Example: "memorable & *inspiring* web applications"

Typographic Techniques

- **Cut-through horizontal rule:** A 1px line horizontally bisects large display headings — creates an architectural, luxury editorial feel
- **Oversized uppercase display text:** Section titles like `ABOUT`, `SKILLS`, `PROJECTS` take up maximum width
- **Monospaced tagline badges:** Short statements in all-caps letter-spaced monospace (`404 NO BUGS FOUND`, `CODE THAT MATTERS. SOLUTIONS THAT GROW`)
- **Code-bracket micro-branding:** Social links rendered as developer syntax: `{LINKEDIN}`, `{GITHUB}`, `{INSTAGRAM}`

3. Layout Structure & Section Design Patterns

Hero Section

- Centered 3D WebGL object (sphere with metallic gold orbiting ring) — built with Three.js or React Three Fiber
- Brand name displayed in oversized uppercase, cut through by a thin 1px horizontal baseline rule
- Floating circular hamburger menu button — top right, minimal, dark pill shape
- No traditional navbar — navigation is hidden until triggered

About Section

- Pitch-black rounded container card floats ON TOP of the light canvas
- Contains: profile photo, short bio, 3–5 bullet-point highlights with custom icons
- Rounded corners: `border-radius: 2rem` or equivalent

Skills Section

- Dark floating card container
- **Sticky category headers:** When scrolling through the skills list, the category title (`Full-Stack Web Development`, `Cloud & DevOps`, `AI & ML`) sticks to the top of the container
- Numbered list items: `01 React`, `02 TypeScript`, `03 Node.js`
- Subcategory description text beneath each numbered item

Experience Section

- **Inverted card:** Light-colored rounded container (inverted from the dark surrounding canvas)
- Left column: Year label (`2024`) — minimal, just the year
- Right column: Dark inner cards with job title, company name, brief description, and tech pill tags

Projects Section

- Editorial **list-view layout** (not card grid)
- Projects separated by **full-width 1px horizontal dividers**
- Each project row: Project name (large, left) + Tech tags (right) + Arrow icon 
- On hover: row highlights or slides
- Very clean, magazine-editorial feel

Navigation Drawer

- Triggered by floating circular hamburger button
- **50% width sliding overlay** from the right — pitch black (`#000000`)
- Navigation links in **oversized bold uppercase** text
- Social links formatted as code: `{LINKEDIN}`, `{GITHUB}`, `{VSCO}`
- Closing X button in the same position as the hamburger

Marquee Tickers

- Dual horizontal scrolling marquees between sections:
- **Dark bar:** White text with star symbol spacers ◆ COLLABORATION ◆ EXCELLENCE ◆ INNOVATION ◆
- **Light bar:** Gold square icon spacers □ GET IN TOUCH □ AVAILABLE FOR PROJECTS □

Contact & Footer

- Large bold callout quote with gold-accented italic words
- Direct email + phone number listed prominently
- Bracketed social links {LINKEDIN} , {GITHUB}
- Scrolling bottom motto in small caps

✨ 4. Animation & Interaction Effects

Interaction	Effect
Hero 3D object	Continuous slow rotation / orbit animation
Section entry	Smooth fade-in + slide-up on scroll into view
Navigation	Sliding panel from right with smooth ease-in-out transition
Project rows	Hover highlight or subtle row color transition
Marquees	CSS <code>animation: marquee</code> infinite loop — two opposing directions
Sticky headers	CSS <code>position: sticky</code> inside scroll containers

💡 5. Actionable Improvements for Nafi's Portfolio

🔴 High Priority (Visual Impact)

1. Alternating contrast rhythm

Alternate between light canvas `#DCDCD9` and pitch-black `#000000` rounded cards. Currently our portfolio likely uses one consistent background — this dual-mode creates structure and drama.

2. Cut-through horizontal rule on section titles

Add a thin 1px line that horizontally bisects large headings like `ABOUT` , `SKILLS` , `PROJECTS` . Simple CSS, huge editorial impact.

3. Editorial projects list-view

Replace card grid for projects with a full-width horizontal list with dividers and `>` external link arrows. Cleaner, more sophisticated.

🟡 Medium Priority (UX Refinement)

4. Sticky skill category headers

In the skills section, implement `position: sticky; top: 0` for category titles so they stay visible as the user scrolls through long skill lists.

5. Sliding navigation drawer

Move from a traditional dropdown or sidebar nav to a 50% width full-height sliding overlay triggered by a minimal floating circular button.

6. Mixed serif + sans-serif typography

Add an italic serif font (Playfair Display or Cormorant Garamond) for 1–2 emphasized keywords in section taglines to break typographic monotony.

● Low Priority (Polish Details)

7. Code-bracket social links

In the contact section or nav, format social links as `{GITHUB}` , `{LINKEDIN}` to reinforce developer identity subtly.

8. Dual marquee tickers

Add contrasting dark + light scrolling ticker bars between major sections. Adds motion and energy.

9. Viewport vignette effect

Add a subtle `radial-gradient` or `box-shadow` vignette inset on the `body` or a fixed overlay to give a cinematic, focused feel.

10. Numbered skill items

Prefix skill list items with zero-padded numbers (`01` , `02` , `03`) for a structured, editorial look.

🔧 6. Implementation Notes for Angular Project

Color Tokens to Add

CSS

```
/* In styles.scss or design-tokens file */
--color-canvas-light: #DCDCD9;
--color-card-dark: #0A0A0A;
--color-accent-gold: #D4AF37;
--color-text-muted: #A1A1AA;
```

Fonts to Import (Google Fonts)

HTML

```
<!-- Space Grotesk for primary display -->
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Space+Grotesk:wght@300;400;500;600;700&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">

<!-- Cormorant Garamond for italic accent -->
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Cormorant+Garamond:ital,wght@1,400;1,600&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">
```

Cut-Through Heading Style

CSS

```
.display-heading {
  position: relative;
  display: inline-block;
}
.display-heading::after {
  content: '';
  position: absolute;
  left: 0;
  right: 0;
  bottom: 35%; /* Adjust to bisect text vertically */
  height: 1px;
  background-color: currentColor;
  pointer-events: none;
}
```

Sticky Category Headers

CSS

```
.skill-category-header {  
  position: sticky;  
  top: 0;  
  background: inherit;  
  z-index: 10;  
  padding: 1rem 0;  
  border-bottom: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.1);  
}
```

Marquee Animation

CSS

```
@keyframes marquee {  
  from { transform: translateX(0); }  
  to   { transform: translateX(-50%); }  
}  
  
.marquee-track {  
  display: flex;  
  animation: marquee 20s linear infinite;  
  width: max-content;  
}
```

Project List Row

CSS

```
.project-row {  
  display: flex;  
  align-items: center;  
  justify-content: space-between;  
  padding: 2rem 0;  
  border-bottom: 1px solid rgba(0,0,0,0.15);  
  cursor: pointer;  
  transition: background 0.2s ease;  
}  
  
.project-row:hover {  
  background: rgba(0,0,0,0.04);  
}
```

Vignette Overlay

CSS

```
body::after {  
  content: '';  
  position: fixed;  
  inset: 0;  
  pointer-events: none;  
  box-shadow: inset 0 0 120px rgba(0,0,0,0.18);  
  z-index: 9999;  
}
```